RESILIENCE ENTREPRENEURSHIP INNOVATION & NATURE

REIN Ghana Hub × Academic City: what ACity brings and what it costs

Internal prep for Gideon Blaauw (CleantechHUB) with Laurence Kalinsky (PVBLIC), before the meeting with Pav, Academic City University (ACity), Accra. 20 October 2026.

1. What ACity brings, in kind

TEC (Technology & Entrepreneurship Center), led by Makafui Awuku, runs the US State Department CCE Climate Tech Accelerator.

In Q3 2025, TEC trained 140 youth in 73 workshops. Participation was 48% female.

Africa's first Sustainability Laboratory was inaugurated on 9 February 2023. It is a CCE initiative, and home of the Telesto Climate Tech Accelerator (17 entrepreneurs in the 2023 cohort).

About 500 students, and 25+ nationalities. AI and Robotics degrees fit PVBLIC ALI (AI Leapfrog Initiative) Logic Centers. International industry mentors 200+ students and educators a year. Northeastern University is a research link. Alumni are at Apple UK and Zipline.

The US State Department CCE stays the anchor. REIN adds a non-US capital channel: FOSD (Family Offices for Sustainable Development) family offices and European corporates. That channel points toward the ACU Foundation's US$10 million goal over three years.

REIN stage	Scale	ACity asset
Ideation	50 participants, 4 weeks	TEC workshops and students
Incubation	25 teams, 10 weeks	Sustainability Lab and Telesto
Acceleration	10 teams, 12 weeks	CCE Climate Tech Accelerator
Growth	4 teams, 12 weeks, investor connections	FOSD and PVBLIC / UNGA
Hub operations		Campus, TEC staff

2. Honest investment

These assets reduce cost and risk. They do not replace cash.

External cash follows a three-year sliding scale. Year 1 is the full funnel, plus setup and integration.

Year	External cash	Level, Year 1 = full bar
Year 1	**US$103,000**	
Year 2	**US$75,000**	
Year 3	**US$50,000**	
3-year total	**US$228,000**	**Sum of the three years**

Year 1 split: programs US$75,000, comms and hub maintenance US$8,000, and operations and integration US$20,000.

External need falls about 50% by Year 3, as ACity takes on delivery and local sponsors come in.

3. Timeline

Gideon has confirmed the Q1 2027 launch: January 2027 is the design month, February 2027 is on-site training, and March 2027 is the start of Incubation. Ideation (4 weeks) sits inside February with that training, so it still comes before Incubation. That February placement is an assumption. Acceleration (12 weeks) and Growth (12 weeks) follow in sequence.

Jan 2027 Design month	**Feb 2027** On-site training Ideation, 4 weeks **Assumption**	**Mar 2027** Incubation starts 10 weeks	**Then** Acceleration 12 weeks	**Then** Growth 12 weeks
21 Oct 2026 Meeting with Pav	**1 Dec 2026** Agreement and Year 1 funding **TO CONFIRM**	**Sept 2027** UNGA82 and Climate Week NYC **Team slots TO CONFIRM**	**2028** Year 2 US$75,000 **TO CONFIRM**	**2029** Year 3 US$50,000 **TO CONFIRM**

UNGA82 opens 7 September 2027. The general debate opens 21 September 2027 (UN schedule). Climate Week NYC is the same month. Exact Climate Week dates are TO CONFIRM. The REIN plan is an SDG Media Zone slot for 2 incubation winners and 2 growth teams. That slot is TO CONFIRM.

4. Top 5 donors in Ghana

Ranked for a university-hosted climate-startup hub that needs a multi-year grant of US$500,000 to US$1 million. Ticket sizes are copied from the public source. Anything not in that source is marked UNVERIFIED.

Donor	Programme	Ticket, sourced	Why it fits	Source
1. GIZ / BMZ	PFS programme with GCIC at Ashesi University. Green incubation and acceleration.	About EUR 1.2 million for the 2024 partnership. Each business can get up to EUR 10,000. Not a US dollar figure.	Closest public match: a Ghana university climate incubator, at a size that covers this ask.	https://ghanacic.ashesi.edu.gh/giz-partners-with-ashesis-gcic-towards-green-entrepreneurship-development/
2. Global Affairs Canada	Supporting the Green Economy of Ghana, through GCIC at Ashesi University.	Maximum contribution $10,000,000 on the Canada project browser (Canadian dollars), 23 Aug 2021 to 31 Mar 2026. Larger than this ask. A follow-on is UNVERIFIED.	Published multi-year grant to a Ghanaian university for climate entrepreneurship.	https://w05.international.gc.ca/projectbrowser-banqueprojets/project-projet/details/p008970001
3. AfDB, YEI MDTF and FAPA	MicroGREEN. Green jobs for youth and women in Ghana and Senegal. Implementer: Invest in Africa.	US$850,000 FAPA grant (11 Aug 2025), plus an initial US$1 million YEI MDTF commitment. Ghana and Senegal share the project.	Programme grants in the target band, already in Ghana. A grant to a university is UNVERIFIED.	https://www.afdb.org/en/news-and-events/press-releases/african-development-bank-and-invest-africa-sign-850000-grant-agreement-boost-inclusive-green-jobs-ghana-and-senegal-85980
4. Danida	Danida Green Business Partnerships, 2025 round. Climate adaptation. Ghana is eligible.	DKK 4 million to 15 million, for 3 to 5 years. Published in kroner, not US dollars. A US dollar conversion is UNVERIFIED.	Size and theme fit. The 2025 rules say a university cannot be the administrative partner, and an international commercial partner is required.	https://danida-business-partnerships.dk/wp-content/uploads/2025/01/DGBP-2025-Guidelines-read-these-if-you-want-to-apply.pdf
5. Mastercard Foundation	Climate Impact Challenge Fund, inside the Fund for Resilience and Prosperity. Ghana is a focus country.	US$250,000 to US$1,500,000 over three years.	Ticket covers the band. Rules require a for-profit SME with at least 3 years of operations, so this fits cohort firms, not the university host. A hub grant is UNVERIFIED.	https://frp.org/sites/default/files/2024-11/Climate%20Impact%20Challenge%20Fund_summary.pdf

Not ranked. USAID: a March 2025 Appropriations letter states that 86% of USAID awards were terminated (https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.dcd.277562/gov.uscourts.dcd.277562.39.18.pdf). Do not plan a new USAID hub grant on the old pipeline. Below this band: FCDO TRANSFORM at GBP 100,000 per enterprise; EU Joint Innovation Facility at EUR 100,000 to 250,000; Orange Corners Ghana at up to EUR 50,000 per entrepreneur. UNDP Ghana Climate Promise is a US$864,000 project with low-value grants. Rockefeller funded the African School of Regulation in Accra at US$1 million (2023) and US$3 million (2024): energy regulation, not a startup hub. SECO GPSCP II is CHF 9 million for cashew and oil palm.